

# Design Engineering Test

## Background

Thanks for taking the time to meet with us and complete our take-home test.

As a Design Technologist at eBay, you'll work across a variety of stacks and routinely explore new and emerging technologies—often ones you haven't worked with before. While that can be challenging, it's also part of what makes the job fun.

The goal of this exercise is to see how you approach building a small product using an unfamiliar technology, a deliberately loose set of requirements, and your own design instincts.

We're interested in how you structure and organize your code, approach the experience and visual design, and make decisions along the way. You'll also have an opportunity to walk us through what you built and discuss your approach.

This is intentionally an MVP. We're more interested in thoughtful decisions than the number of features you can build.

## The Test

eBay's homegrown web / JavaScript framework is [Marko](#). Since it's unlikely you've worked with Marko before, we'd like you to build a *simple* Marko app that searches an external API and displays the results.

## Elements/Components

At a minimum, your app should include:

- Header
- Search bar
- Grid of cards / blocks for search results
- Basic footer
- A way to view a selected item (modal, separate view, etc.)

You won't be given a design to follow, so use your best judgment as a creative technologist.

## Project Ideas

We want this project to be fun to build, so here are a few ideas based on freely available APIs. Feel free to use one of these or choose your own.

- Realtime News search of the [News API](#)
- Realtime Gif search using the [Giphy API](#)
- Realtime Image Search using [Pexels API](#) or [Unsplash API](#)
- Realtime Products Search using [Product Hunt API](#)
- Realtime Cryptocurrencies Search with a Crypto API like [CoinLayer](#)

## References

- [Marko Run](#)
- [Builder HackerNews clone with Marko](#)
- [Up and running with marko and vite](#)

## Agentic Workflow

AI-assisted development is increasingly part of how we build products, and **you're welcome to use AI tools while completing this exercise**. Use AI however it naturally fits into your workflow: learning Marko, exploring ideas, generating or refactoring code, debugging, or reviewing your work.

During your walkthrough, be prepared to discuss how you used AI, the decisions you made, and how you evaluated or modified its output. Ultimately, you should be able to understand, explain, and take ownership of the work you submit.

## Notes

- **Please spend around 3(ish) hours on this.** This is intentionally an MVP—we don't expect a production-ready application.
- Design and development are equally important. **Make it look good.** Keep the design simple but considered. You're free to express the UI however you want.
- Think about the user as if this were a real experience. What's the initial state? What happens while searching or loading? What about empty states, image loading, pagination, or load more?
- Consider thoughtful uses of motion and microinteractions where they improve the experience.

## Requirements

- **Styling** — Do not use CSS or UI libraries. Build your styles from scratch. PostCSS, LESS, or other CSS preprocessors are fine.
- **Responsive** — Build mobile-first and responsive. We'll check your work at various screen sizes.
- **Organization** — Structure the project as you would any other project.
- **Running locally** — We should be able to install, build, and run the app locally without major errors.

## For bonus points

If time permits, here are a few ways to take the project further. These are optional and shouldn't come at the expense of the core experience.

- **Storybook** — Integrate Storybook for at least one component, with ~3 stories demonstrating different inputs / properties. See [Storybook for Marko](#) and [eBay CoreUI](#) for examples.
- **Tests** — Add snapshots or unit tests. See [Marko Testing Library](#), [Marko Jest](#), and CoreUI for examples.
- **Deploy** — We'll pull your repo and run it locally, but feel free to deploy your project somewhere we can view it as well.

## Submitting

Submit your work as a GitHub repository. If you'd prefer to keep the repository private, share it with [github.com/stephenscaff](https://github.com/stephenscaff).